

Sixth century B.C.E. - Political Condition

1. In ancient times, the area to the south of the Ganga was known as

(a) Anarta (b) Takshashila
(c) Chola (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (e)

In ancient times the area along rivers to the south of Ganga was known as Magadha. Takshashila was situated between the Indus and Jhelum. Chola was situated in the south of Godavari river. Anarta was a Vedic era kingdom of ancient India. Hence option (e) None of the above is correct answer.

2. Who founded Pataliputra?

(a) Udayin (b) Ashoka
(c) Bimbisara (d) Mahapadmanada

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (*)

Pataliputra was founded by Ajatashatru, who was the successor of Bimbisara. He built a fort at the confluence of the Son and Ganga rivers. Udayin shifted the capital of the Magadha Empire from Rajgriha to Pataliputra. However, the Bihar Public Service Commission has allowed answer option (a).

3. By which ruler Pataliputra was chosen as the capital for the first time?

(a) Ajatashatru (b) Kalashoka
(c) Udayin (d) Kanishka

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. Which ruler founded the beautiful city, Pataliputra?

(a) Ajatashatru (b) Bimbisara
(c) Bindusara (d) Udayin
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (a)

Pataliputra was founded by Ajatashatru, who was the successor of Bimbisara. Udayin shifted the capital of Magadha Empire from Rajgriha to Pataliputra.

5. Which ruler had made Pataliputra the capital of his empire for the first time?

(a) Chandragupta Maurya
(b) Ashoka the Great
(c) Chandragupta Vikramaditya
(d) Kanishka

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (a)

Pataliputra was established by Ajatashatru, the ruler of Haryanka dynasty at the confluence of the Son and Ganga rivers and Udayin transferred his capital from Rajgriha to Pataliputra. But Udayin is not mentioned in the above options. Here, Chandragupta Maurya will be the correct answer.

6. According to the Mahavamsa, Bimbisara ascended the throne at the age of

(a) 15 years (b) 18 years
(c) 20 years (d) 21 years
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (a)

Bimbisara was the king of the Magadha Empire in eastern India. Bimbisara was the son of Bhattiya. He ascended to throne at the age of 15. He established the Haryanka dynasty and laid the foundation of Magadha with the fortification of a village, which later became the city of Pataliputra.

7. In which century did the first Magadhan Empire rise?

(a) Fourth Century B.C. (b) Sixth Century B.C.
(c) Second Century B.C. (d) First Century B.C.

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

The first Magadhan empire flourished in the 6th century B.C. The actual founder of this empire was King Bimbisara (approximately 544-492 century B.C.). He was related to the Haryanka dynasty.

8. Which was the first capital of ancient Mahajanapada Magadh?

(a) Pataliputra (b) Vaishali
(c) Champa (d) Anga
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2020

Ans. (e)

Magadh was an ancient kingdom in southern Bihar. Its first capital was Rajgriha (Modern day Rajgir) which was also known as Girivraj. During the reign of Udayin (Haryanka dynasty), the Capital was moved to Patliputra.

9. Which one was the capital of Magadh?

- (a) Pataliputra (b) Vaishali
(c) Girivraj (Rajagriha) (d) Champa

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (*)

In the given options two options (a) and (c) are correct. The initial capital, of Magadha was Girivraj, later Udayin made Pataliputra the capital, which remained the capital of Magadha till the Gupta period. Different details are found in Buddhist texts and Puranas regarding the first dynasty that ruled the Magadha empire. According to the Puranas. The first king of this dynasty was Jarasandha, who made Girivraj his capital.

10. Magadha and Anga plains are parts of which of the following?

- (a) Upper Ganga Valley (b) Middle Ganga Valley
(c) Lower Ganga Valley (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. School Teacher (Class 6-8) 10-12-2023

Ans. (b)

Magadha and Anga plains are the parts of Middle Ganga Valley.

11. By whom the first republic of the world was established in Vaishali –

- (a) Maurya (b) Nanda
(c) Gupta (d) Lichchhavi

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

The Lichchhavi dynasty of Vaishali established the first republic in the world. Vaishali took its name from King Vishal of the Mahabharata era. Vaishali is a great Buddhist pilgrimage and also the birthplace of Lord Mahavira.

12. Where was the world's first republican system in the sixth century BC?

- (a) Vaishali (b) Athens
(c) Sparta (d) Pataliputra

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003-04

Ans. (a)

The world's first republic system was in Vaishali in the sixth century B.C. In fact, in the 6th century B.C., where there was monarchical governance was prevalent in two states named. Vajji and Malla. Vajji was a confederation of 8 states, in which the lichchhavis of Vaishali were the most powerful.

13. The list of sixteen Mahajanapadas is available in –

- (a) Mahabharata (b) Anguttar Nikaya

(c) Chandogya Upanishad (d) Samyukta Nikaya

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (b)

The 16 Mahajanapadas of 6th century B.C. were mentioned in Buddhist text 'Anguttara Nikaya' and Jain text 'Bhagwati Sutra'.

14. Which was the capital of Magadha?

- (a) Pratishthan (b) Vaishali
(c) Rajgriha (d) Champa

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

Rajgriha was the first capital of Magadha. Where the first 'Buddhist Council' was organized and Lord Mahavir sermoned first). According to Puranas, the first dynasty to rule over Magadh was Brihadrath dynasty. King Brihadrath's son, Jarasandha, made Girivraja (Rajgir) his capital. Later on, Udayin, son of Ajatashatru, moved the capital to Patliputra.

15. Which was the initial capital of Magadha?

- (a) Pataliputra (b) Vaishali
(c) Girivraja (Rajgriha) (d) Champa

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

16. What was the name of the dynasty of Ajatashatru?

- (a) Maurya (b) Haryanka
(c) Nanda (d) Gupta

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

Ajatashatru (492-460 BC) belonged to Haryanka dynasty. He became king after killing his father Bimbisara.

17. Who was the Physician of Magadh ruler Bimbisara?

- (a) Shilabhadra (b) Vijayasena
(c) Jeevaka (d) Manu
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (c)

Jeevaka was the doctor of Bimbisara the ruler of Magadha. Bimbisara also sent him for the treatment of Awanti Naresh Chand Pradyot.

18. Which dynasty did rule over Magadha after Nanda Dynasty?

- (a) Maurya (b) Shunga
(c) Gupta (d) Kushana

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (a)